Decision Log

This page records each project decision, the options, and the reason. It is also the change log for the scope. Add a new row for each new decision. Do not delete old rows. If a decision changes, add a new row that replaces the old one.

Decisions

ID	Date	Decision	Options	Reason	Type
D01	Oct 21, 2026	v1 reads Jira only. GitHub Issues is in v2.	Jira only; GitHub only; both in v1	One source is sufficient to prove the core logic. The code puts the data source behind one interface, so a second source is easy to add.	SCOPE
D02	Oct 21, 2026	Rules in the code set the RAG status. The AI does not set it.	Rules; AI; AI with rules as a check	Rules give the same result each time. An executive can see the reason for the status.	DESIGN
D03	Oct 21, 2026	Claude gets only	Full ticket data;	Less data keeps	DESIGN

		counts, ticket titles, the RAG status, and the reason. Claude does not get descriptions or comments.	summary data only	private information out, keeps the cost low, and gives the AI fewer chances to add facts that are not true.	
D04	Oct 21, 2026	Miro and Confluence are project management tools in v1. Confluence output is a product feature in v2. Miro is not part of the product.	Project tools only; product parts; both	v1 stays small. A status report needs no data from a Miro board.	SCOPE
D05	Oct 21, 2026	Claude does the build work. We discuss each step before and after the work. The product	Product owner does the work; Claude does the work without discussion; Claude	The product owner must understand and explain each part of the tool. The RAID	METHOD

		owner makes each decision.	does the work with discussion	Log Extractor did not give this understanding.	
D06	Oct 21, 2026	Make the Confluence charter before the Miro board.	Confluence first; Miro first	The charter sets the scope. The Miro diagrams show how the tool works inside that scope.	METHOD
D07	Oct 21, 2026	The product owner makes the space and the charter page by hand one time. Claude makes the other pages with the Atlassian connector.	All by hand; all with the connector; a combination	The product owner sees the Confluence steps one time. Then the time goes to the content.	METHOD
D08	Oct 21, 2026	Add Slack to v2. The tool sends a short	Slack in v1; Slack in v2; no Slack	Many teams read updates in	SCOPE CHANGE

		message with the RAG status, a short summary, and a link to the full report on Confluence.		Slack. Confluence holds the full report, and Slack points to it. Slack needs the Confluence link, which is in v2.	
D09	Oct 21, 2026	Start on Oct 22. Estimate from the real speed of the RAID Log Extractor (2 days). Show one buffer day with a clear name.	Long plan, then cut it; estimate from real data with a clear buffer	A plan that is made long and then cut shows poor estimates. Real data gives an honest plan.	SCHEDULE
D10	Oct 21, 2026	Call the method "hybrid," not Scrum.	Scrum; hybrid	Scrum needs a team with three accountabilities. This is a solo project, so the method is tailored.	METHOD

D11	Oct 21, 2026	The file config.yaml is the source of the RAG rules. The Confluence page explains the rules.	Rules in Confluence; rules in config.yaml; rules in both	Rules in two places become different over time. One source prevents this problem.	DESIGN
D12	Oct 21, 2026	Add an AI evaluation set to the tests.	Unit tests only; unit tests and an AI evaluation set	Unit tests check the code, but not the AI summary. The evaluation set measures the quality of the summary.	DESIGN
D13	Oct 21, 2026	Accept the Definition of Ready and the Definition of Done. They apply to the user stories for the tool. A Sprint 0 plan task is done when the product	One list for all work; separate rules for plan tasks	Items such as "unit tests pass" have no meaning for a Confluence page. A separate rule keeps the lists correct for each type of work.	METHOD

		owner reviews it and agrees with it.			
D14	Oct 21, 2026	The project board has a "Blocked" status. A ticket goes into "Blocked" only when it has a blocker. If it has no blocker, it goes from "In Progress" directly to "Review." The tool also supports the flag and the label methods in config.yaml for other teams.	Blocked status; flag; label	The status is easy to see on the board. The time in the status gives a correct "days blocked" number.	DESIGN
D15	Oct 21, 2026	Stories, tasks, and bugs use	Free movement between	A controlled workflow	METHOD

		one workflow: To Do, In Progress, Blocked (only if necessary), Review, and Done. Only the product owner moves a ticket to Done. Claude moves tickets only as far as Review. **Changed by D31.**	statuses; a controlled workflow with approval by the product owner	is the standard. The approval step makes sure that the product owner checks each ticket against the Definition of Done. The connector uses the product owner's account, so a Jira rule cannot stop Claude. The control is a work rule.	
D16	Oct 21, 2026	RAG limits for v1. Red: one or more high-priority tickets are	These limits; other limits	Simple limits that an executive can understand. The	DESIGN

		blocked, or more than 20% of open tickets are overdue. Amber: one or more tickets are blocked, or the team closed fewer tickets than it opened. Green: none of these conditions are true. **Replaced by D21.**		limits are in config.yaml, so a team can change them. We will look at them again after v1.	
D17	Oct 21, 2026	One Jira project only (SRG, Scrum, team-managed). No second project for test data. The tool runs one time against SRG to	A second test data project; simulated data and one real run	Simulated data tests the logic with less setup. Only the connection needs real Jira. This keeps v1 small.	SCOPE

		test the real connection. The README states that the tool is tested on team-managed projects only. A company-managed test moves to v2.			
D18	Oct 21, 2026	Test strategy: (1) a few planned scenarios with known results; (2) a simple random generator with a fixed seed that tries to break the tool; (3) a minimum set of properties that must be true in	Planned tests only; random tests only; both, with a real run	Planned tests prove that the rules are correct. Random tests find cases that nobody thought of. The real run tests the Jira connection.	DESIGN

		each random run; (4) one real run against SRG. Each failure becomes a permanent test.			
D19	Oct 21, 2026	The tool counts a ticket as closed by the date when it moved into a "Done" category status. It uses the "Resolved " date only as a second check. Priority and Due date must be on all work types.	Resolved date only; Done status date	Some Jira projects do not set the resolution. Without due dates, the tool counts zero overdue tickets and shows green by mistake.	DESIGN
D20	Oct 21, 2026	Estimate stories in story points (1,	Days only; story points only; both	Story points are the normal practice in	METHOD

		2, 3, 5, or 8) in Jira. Also track planned days against actual days for each sprint in this log. The random generator makes simulated team data (for example, 25 people) with story points to test the tool.		companies that use Scrum in Jira. Days give an honest record of plan against actual. Simulated team numbers test the tool, but they never describe this project. Four short sprints with one person do not give a reliable velocity.	
D21	Oct 21, 2026	Each open ticket gets a status. The tool checks in this order: Black if overdue; Red if blocked; Amber if due in the next 2	Keep D16; a ticket status with a priority matrix	The executive sees where the problems are, not only one colour. A red P1 ticket and a red P5 ticket are not equal.	SCOPE CHANGE

		days and not in Review; Green for all other open tickets. Done tickets are counted separately. The report shows a matrix of ticket status against priority P1 (Highest) to P5 (Lowest). The match of Jira priority names to P1 to P5 is in config.yaml. The project status uses only red, amber, and green: Red if one or more P1 or P2 tickets are		P1 to P5 match the five Jira priority levels. Black separates late work from stopped work. The extra work is about half a day in Sprint 2.	

		red or black; Amber if one or more P3 to P5 tickets are red or black, or one or more P1 or P2 tickets are amber, or the team closed fewer tickets than it opened; Green if none of these are true. The report always writes the status as a word next to the colour. This decision replaces D16. **The amber rule is changed by D22.**			

D22	Oct 21, 2026	Change the amber rule for tickets in D21. A ticket is amber only if it is due in the next 2 days and it is still in To Do. A ticket that is in progress near its due date stays green. All other rules in D21 stay the same. A rule for stuck work (no change for 3 or more days) moves to v2.	A: not started; B: shorter window (1 day); C: no movement for 3 days; D: a limit at the project level	Most people finish work near the due date. With the old rule, the project would be amber almost every week, and people would stop reading the report (alert fatigue). "Due soon and not started" is a real risk that a manager can act on. If the work is really late, the ticket becomes black the next day.	DESIGN
D23	Oct 22, 2026	The tool counts only stories,	Count all work types; count only	An epic and its stories describe	DESIGN

		tasks, and bugs. It does not count epics or subtasks. The list of work types to count is in config.yaml.	stories, tasks, and bugs	the same work. If the tool counts both, it counts the same work two times. Other teams use other work types, so the list must be easy to change.	
D24	Oct 22, 2026	Engineering standards: (1) each ticket has its own branch, and the branch name starts with the Jira key; (2) each commit message starts with the Jira key; (3) code goes into the main	Direct changes to the main branch; branches with pull requests and automatic checks	These are the standard practices of a software team. They link each change to its ticket, stop errors and secrets before the merge, and make the public repository legally usable. The	METHOD

		branch only by a pull request; (4) GitHub Actions runs the tests, a style check, and a secret scan on each pull request; (5) the repository has an MIT license; (6) .gitignore excludes the .env file and the report output folder; (7) dependency versions are fixed in the requirements file; (8) the Development field is on Story,		Development field was removed by mistake in an earlier step.	

		Task, and Bug.			
D25	Oct 22, 2026	Security and cost: (1) config.yaml has an option to hide ticket titles from the AI; (2) config.yaml sets a maximum number of tokens for each run; (3) the README shows the expected cost for each run; (4) the tool only reads from Jira and never changes Jira data.	Send all titles with no limit; titles with an option to hide, and a cost limit	Ticket titles can contain customer names or confidential project names. A security review checks what data leaves a company. Each external service needs a budget.	DESIGN
D26	Oct 22, 2026	Governance practices: (1) a RAID Log page, reviewed in each sprint review; (2)	Skip the practices that a solo project does not need; use all standard practices	The product owner wants to practise each standard practice of a software	METHOD

		a Requirements section with non-functional requirements on the RAG Rules page; (3) a go or no-go checklist that the product owner approves before the release; (4) a Daily Stand-up page with short daily notes; (5) a Stakeholders page with a RACI chart and a communication plan; (6) a Severity field on bugs (S1 to S4); (7) one release		team, so that each practice can be explained from real use. An earlier proposal to skip items 4 to 7 is not used.	

		entity: the Jira release "v1.0.0" and the GitHub tag "v1.0.0" have the same name, and each ticket in the release has this Fix version.			
D27	Oct 22, 2026	Non-functional requirements: (1) a report in less than 2 minutes for a project with up to 500 tickets; (2) Python 3.11 or newer; (3) the cost limit is a token limit in config.yaml, and the	No size for the speed goal; a size limit. Fixed dollar limit; token limit.	A size makes the speed test clear. Python 3.11 is widely used and supported. Prices change, but a token limit stays correct.	DESIGN

		README shows the expected cost. No fixed dollar amount.			
D28	Oct 22, 2026	Assignee names, reporter names, and email addresses never go to the AI. The full report still shows the owner of each ticket.	Send names; never send names	Names are personal data, and the summary does not need them. This also prevents blame on a person in the summary.	DESIGN
D29	Oct 22, 2026	Each ticket has a short brief: (1) move to In Progress before work; (2) goal; (3) steps; (4) done check; (5) move to Review when complete. Mark each action as	No brief; a brief for each ticket	A brief makes the work clear before it starts (Sprint 0 retrospecti ve).	METHOD

		done. Keep the brief short.			
D30	Oct 22, 2026	The budget limit for the Claude API is the prepaid credit balance, with auto-reload off. No monthly spend limit in the Console.	Monthly spend limit; prepaid credits with auto-reload off	The API stops when the balance is zero, so the cost cannot go above the credits. The token limit in config.yaml (D25) also limits each run.	METHOD
D31	Oct 22, 2026	From Sprint 2, Claude does the repeated steps after the product owner approves in chat ("approve SRG-xx"): merge the pull request, delete the branch, and move	Product owner does each click; Claude does the clicks after an approval in chat	Six pull requests gave enough practice (Sprint 1 retrospective). The approval stays the control. The Jira comment keeps a record of each approval.	METHOD

		the ticket to Done. Claude adds a Jira comment with the date of the approval. The product owner tests on the Mac only when a ticket touches Jira or the Claude API. This changes D15.			
D32	Oct 22, 2026	The public repository has PDF copies of the key Confluence pages in a docs folder, made at the v1.0.0 release. Confluence stays the live source. The space	Public space (needs a paid plan); remove the link; PDF copies at release	Anonymous access is not available on the Confluence Free plan. A recruiter reads GitHub. A copy at the release is a fixed record, like a	SCOPE

		stays private.		tagged release, and costs nothing.	
D33	`Oct 23, 2026`	Amber uses a status category, not a status name: `amber_status_category: To Do`. "Due within 2 days" means today, tomorrow, or the day after. For a finished week, "today" is the Monday after the week. Logged late (SRG-37).	Status name; status category	Teams rename their statuses ("Backlog", "Open"). A category works for each team (Sprint 1 review C2).	DESIGN
D34	`Oct 23, 2026`	A ticket with an unknown priority is in an "Unmappe	Count as high; count as low; separate column	The tool must not guess a high priority. The	DESIGN

		d" column. For the project status it counts as a lower priority, not as P1 or P2. The report shows a warning for it. Logged late (SRG-37).	with a warning	warning makes the team fix its priority names in config.yaml.	
D35	Oct 23, 2026	The AI input has, for each non-green or closed ticket: key, P-level, ticket status, days blocked, and title (unless hidden). Green tickets are only in the counts. Logged late (SRG-37).	All tickets; non-green and closed tickets only	The summary is about risks and progress. Fewer tickets keep the input small and the cost low for big projects. No personal data is added (D28).	DESIGN
D36	Oct 23, 2026	The tool checks	Trust the answer;	The rules set the	DESIGN

		each AI answer: agreed JSON form, 3 to 5 sentences, 1 to 5 "Next week" items, only known ticket keys, and the project status from the rules. A failed check removes the summary and adds a warning. Logged late (SRG-37).	check the answer	status (D02). A wrong summary is worse than no summary.	
D37	Oct 23, 2026	The token limit for each run is 8000 (input and output). The tool estimates the tokens before the call and	2000; 8000	2000 was too small for a 26-ticket week with titles. A real run used about 900 tokens.	DESIGN

		makes no call above the limit. Logged late (SRG-37).			
D38	Oct 23, 2026	Stacked pull requests: each branch builds on the one before it, and the merges run in order. The product owner can approve many tickets at one time. Logged late (SRG-37).	One ticket at a time with a merge each; stacked pull requests	It keeps one branch for each ticket (D24) and allows one approval for many tickets (D31).	METHOD
D39	Oct 23, 2026	Prevention rules from the Sprint 2 technical review (Lessons Learned Log L05 to L10): (1) merge first, then	No fixed rules; written rules	The Sprint 2 review found the same kind of gap in the process and the documents. Written rules stop it from	METHOD

		Done; (2) each commit holds only the work of its own ticket; (3) at most 2 tickets In Progress; (4) each pull request lists its decisions, and each one goes into this log before Review; (5) a ticket that changes a rule also changes its page; (6) each sprint review uses a checklist: tickets, Decision Log, RAID Log, rule pages, README.		happening again.	
D40	Oct 23, 2026	The CI pins each	Tags; SHA pins with	A moved tag cannot	METHOD

		GitHub action to a commit SHA. A second job runs the tests on Python 3.12 and 3.13; the required check (3.11) keeps its name. Dependabot proposes pip and action updates each week (SRG-37).	no updates; SHA pins with Dependabot	change the CI. Dependabot keeps the pins current. The README tells users to install 3.12, so the CI must test it.	
D41	Oct 23, 2026	The AI status check (SRG-34): the first sentence must state the rule status; the tool removes a summary with a negation before the status	Word present only; fixed first sentence only; word check with negation and claim checks	The old check accepted "The project is not Red" (G1). A removed summary is safe: the report still runs with a warning (SRG-25).	GUARDRAIL

		word (not, no longer, rather than, from), a different status for the project, or soft words (on track, healthy, no risks) about a project that is not Green. The prompt tells the AI to start with "The project is <status>."			
D42	Oct 23, 2026	Text from Jira or the AI in the Markdown report is made safe (SRG-35): "<", ">", and "&" become HTML entities, line breaks become spaces,	Escape "|" only; strip HTML; escape as entities	Entities show the text as the user typed it and cannot run as HTML. Spaces keep each table row on one line (B1, B2).	METHOD

		and "|" is escaped in table cells. The random tests check that each table row has the same number of cells as its header.			
D43	Oct 23, 2026	Each part of the project status reason names at most 3 ticket keys, then "and N more" (SRG-36). The counts stay exact. The Tickets table lists each ticket. The AI input still lists each ticket that is not green, so	All keys; counts only; at most 3 keys	40 keys gave a reason of 343 characters (B3). An executive reads the reason in one line. 3 keys show where to look first.	METHOD

		the AI can name any of them.			
D44	`Oct 23, 2026`	Replaces the soft-word part of D41 (SRG-38): for a project that is not Green, the tool removes a summary with "on track", "healthy", "no risks", "no concerns", "no issues", or "all good" in any sentence or Next week item. The prompt forbids these words. For a failed sample, the evaluation prints	Sentences with "project" only (D41); anywhere in the summary	The evaluation run after SRG-34 found "on track" in a Red week, in a sentence without "project". A reader takes it as the status of the project.	`GUARDRAIL`

		what the AI wrote.			
D45	Oct 23, 2026	Markdown report layout (SRG-27): the sections of the story in its order, then Warnings and All tickets at the end. Status marks: ⚫ Black, 🔴 Red, 🟠 Amber, 🟢 Green, ✅ Done, each with the word. An empty list says "None." File name <project>-<ISO year>-W<ISO week>, also for the HTML file. Days overdue and days blocked	Story sections only; story sections plus Warnings and All tickets	Warnings tell the reader about removed AI text and unmapped priorities. All tickets keeps the full list after the 3-key cap in the reason (D43). Emoji marks work in Markdown with no images.	METHOD

		are counted at the end of the week.			
D46	Oct 23, 2026	HTML report (SRG-28): one content model (build_sections) feeds both the Markdown and the HTML renderer, so both files have the same sections and data. The HTML file has inline CSS only (no script, image, font, or link). Status badges have a colour, a word, and a shape (■ Black, ● Red, ▲	Separate renderers; a template engine (Jinja2); one content model with two small renderers	One content model makes a difference between the formats impossible. No new dependency. The shape keeps each status clear in black-and-white print and for colour-blind readers.	METHOD

		Amber, ◆ Green, ✓ Done). In print, badges are black on white. Wide tables scroll on a phone.			
D47	Oct 23, 2026	Sample report and docs (SRG-29): the sample in examples/ uses a made-up project DEMO and a sample summary text. The text passes the real AI answer checks and is labelled "Sample text", not "Written by AI". A test keeps the sample	A real AI answer in the sample; a sample with no summary; a labelled sample text	A real AI answer changes at each run and needs the API key in CI. A labelled sample text is honest and shows the full layout. The PDFs must show the pages at v1.0.0.	METHOD

		the same as the script output. The Confluence PDFs go into docs/ at the release (SRG-31), after a check for private data.			
D48	Oct 23, 2026	Release by tag (SRG-31, action A7): a version tag such as v1.0.0 starts the Release workflow. It checks that the tag equals the version in pyproject.toml, runs the style check and all tests, builds the package, and publishes	Manual release on the GitHub page; automatic release on each merge; release by tag after "Go"	The same steps each time, with no step forgotten. The "Go" decision stays with a person. Each release is a fixed point that the tag, the Jira version, and the docs share (D26).	METHOD

		the GitHub release with the notes from CHANGELOG.md, the package, and the sample report. A person pushes the tag only after the product owner writes "Go" (D26).			
D49	Oct 23, 2026	The AI answers through a tool with a fixed schema (write_summary: summary, next_week), and the call forces this tool (SRG-40). A text answer with JSON stays as a	Better text parsing; JSON mode in the prompt only; a tool schema	The real run removed the summary as "not in the agreed form". Real titles have quotes, and free-text JSON breaks on one unescaped quote. With a tool, the	GUARDRAIL

		fallback. Each form error states its reason: no JSON object, the JSON error and position, a missing field, or the output limit. A sixth evaluation sample has titles with quotes, braces, and a line break.		API returns a parsed object.	
D50	Oct 23, 2026	Replaces the tool part of D49 (SRG-40): the call uses structured outputs (output_config.format with a JSON schema), not a forced	Forced tool (D49); tool_choice auto with strict; structured outputs	Real run 2 gave a 400 error: Claude Sonnet 5.5 refuses tool_choice "tool" and "any" (Anthropic tool use documentation). Structured outputs support	GUARDRAIL

		tool. An API error in the warning states its type, status, and message (at most 200 characters, no secret).		Sonnet 5.5 and return JSON in the schema. A test now checks that the call has no forced tool and that the schema uses only supported keywords.	
D51	Oct 23, 2026	The AI call sets output_config.effort to "low", and the output limit is 2000 tokens (was 600). The run limit stays at 8000 tokens (SRG-40).	Keep 600; raise the limit only; low effort and a higher limit	Real run 3 stopped at 600 output tokens. Claude Sonnet 5.5 thinks before it answers, and thinking counts toward max_tokens (Anthropic adaptive thinking documentation). A summary of facts	METHOD

				needs little thinking. Cost at the limit stays less than US$0.04 for each run.	

Plan against actual

Complete this table at the end of each sprint.

Sprint	Planned dates	Planned days	Actual days	Notes
Sprint 0	Oct 22	1	2 (Oct 21 evening and Oct 22)	The work started early, on the evening of Oct 21 (charter, Decision Log, Definition of Ready, and Definition of Done). The connector failed (I05), and 3 to 4 hours were lost. The work continued by hand.
Sprint 1	Oct 23 – Oct 24	2	0.5 (Oct 22)	7 of 7 tickets, 10 story

				points. Done on the same day as Sprint 0, 1.5 days ahead of plan. Review: Sprint 1 Review and Retrospective
Sprint 2	Oct 25 – Oct 26	2	0.5 (Oct 23)	8 of 8 tickets, 16 story points (SRG-33 added from the Sprint 1 review). Done 2 days before the plan. AI evaluation set 5 of 5. Review: Sprint 2 Review and Retrospective
Sprint 3	Oct 27	1	1 (Oct 23)	13 tickets, with 5 bugs found and fixed in the sprint (2 from the real run). Go on Oct 23, 4 days before the plan. The buffer day was not

				needed. Review: Sprint 3 Review and Retrospective.
Buffer	Oct 28	0 (only for problems)		

Sprint reviews and retrospectives

Add a short entry at the end of each sprint: what we finished, what went well, and what we will change.

- Sprint 0: Sprint 0 Review and Retrospective
- Sprint 1: Sprint 1 Review and Retrospective
- Sprint 2: Sprint 2 Review and Retrospective
- Sprint 3: Sprint 3 Review and Retrospective